

Case Tatro

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Academic Positions

Hamilton College

Visiting Assistant Professor, Economics

Clinton, NY

2026

Education

Binghamton University

PhD, Economics

Binghamton, NY

2021–2026

Hamilton College

BA, Economics

Clinton, NY

2014–2018

Research and Teaching Interests:

Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Environmental/Behavioral Economics,
Applied Microeconomics

Research

Awards

- Cliff R. Kern Excellence in Research Award, 2025.

Job Market Paper

Should Value-Added Models Weight All Students Equally?

Abstract: Conventional value-added (VA) models estimate teacher quality as a simple average of the difference between students' actual and predicted standardized test scores. These models therefore implicitly assume it is just as important to raise test scores of lower-achieving students as it is to raise test scores of higher-achieving students. I consider whether a weighted average of residuals might be more useful. Using data from North Carolina, I find that teacher VA measures become more predictive of teachers' long-run impacts when the lowest-achieving students are weighted more than the median student. These differences in weights may reflect either (i) small-sample efficiency (some students are more informative about teachers' true test-score effects than others) or (ii) differences in true effects (e.g., test-score effects for different students might capture different general aspects of teaching). I find empirical evidence supporting both explanations. In particular, the large weights for higher-achieving students are partially but not completely explained by the fact that their residuals are less noisy.

Working Papers

Is the Mortality Gap Between Red and Blue States Caused by Government?

(With Jijeebisha Bhattacharai and David Slichter)

Abstract: In the US, age-adjusted mortality rates are higher in “red” states, i.e., states with high support for the Republican Party. We ask whether this is due to state-level policies as opposed to confounding variables such as culture. Using a variety of empirical approaches, we find that state policy explains between 0 and 20% of the mortality gap. Scaling this by the size of the (large) gap, red state policies increase mortality risk by 0–3% relative to blue state policies.

Is the Achievement Gap Between Red and Blue States Caused by Government?

Abstract: In the US, the general consensus is that Democrats exhibit greater support for education, including funding education more generously. Consistent with this fact, students in Democratic states score higher on standardized tests than those in Republican states. I implement two research designs and ask whether a state's partisan orientation (measured through vote shares in presidential elections) causes these differences in test scores through state-level policy. I find no causal impact of state partisanship on test scores. Further, despite the view that Democrats promote equity in education, I do not find that increasing the degree of Democratic lean causally closes achievement gaps between white and black students, male and female students, or rich and poor students. I also do not find heterogeneous effects across demographic sub-groups, grades, or subjects using either of my two research designs.

Works in Progress.....

The Effects of Accountable Advice

(With Ozlem Tonguc)

Abstract: The literature on advised decision making finds that a third-party advisor allows a decision maker to deflect blame for an unfair action and largely escape accountability for this unfair action. In the context of the consulting industry, we ask whether direct accountability of the third-party advisor, i.e., a consulting company, may change both the advice of a third-party advisor and ultimately whether or not the decision maker chooses a fair or unfair action. We answer this question by conducting a lab experiment in which we vary whether the advisor is accountable or not. We find that direct accountability reduces the probability of both unfair advice and unfair action. We speculate that such accountability applied to the consulting industry may reduce the intrinsic value of firms hiring a consultant through this accountability channel but do not expect firms to no longer hire such agencies as a result.

Conference Acceptances and Presentations.....

- Finger-Lakes Region Economics of Education Workshop, 2026 (In-person)
- Capital Region Applied Microeconomics Workshop, 2026 (In-person)
- Southern Economic Association, 2025 (In-person)
- Econometric Society, 2024 North American Summer Meeting (In-person)
- Canadian Economics Association, 2024 (Online)

Conference Attendances.....

- Northeast Economics of Education Workshop, 2026 (In-person)
- Center for Teaching and Learning Economics (CTALE), 2024 (Online)
- Southern Economic Association, 2024 (In-person)
- Teaching at Teaching Intensive Institutions, 2024 (In-person)

Teaching Experience & Training

- Binghamton University Campus-wide Graduate-Student Teaching Award, 2024
- **Hamilton College**
 - Econ 560: Honors Research Seminar, Spring 2027 (*in-person*)
 - Econ 380: Environmental Economics, Spring 2027 (*in-person*)
 - Econ 100: Intro to Economics, Fall 2026 (*in-person*)
 - Econ 339: Behavioral Economics, Fall 2026 (*in-person*)

○ Binghamton University

- *Instructor of Record*
 - Econ 331: Environmental Economics, Fall 2025 (*in-person*)
 - Econ 360: Microeconomic Theory, Summer 2024, Summer 2025 (*in-person*)
- *Teaching Assistant*
 - Natural Resource Economics, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026 (*includes guest lectures*)
 - Environmental Economics, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025 (*includes guest lectures*)
 - Microeconomics (PhD), Fall 2023 (*includes discussion sections*)
 - Historical Perspectives of Economic Growth, Spring 2023 (*includes guest lectures*)
 - International Monetary Policy, Fall 2022 (*includes guest lectures*)
 - Macroeconomic Theory, Spring 2022 (*includes discussion sections*)
 - Microeconomic Theory, Fall 2021 (*includes discussion sections*)
- *Evidence-Based Teacher Training*
 - Evidence-Based Teaching Institute (Attendee), Spring 2025
 - Wicked Graduate Teaching Workshop (Guest Lecturer & Attendee), Fall 2024
 - Scholarly Teaching (Student), Fall 2023

Private Sector Experience

Edgeworth Economic Consulting

Senior Economic Consultant

Washington, DC

Jul 2018 – Jul 2021

- Managed teams of up to six analysts to develop and create pricing and regression analyses, primarily used in price-fixing antitrust testimony pertaining to the pharmaceutical, airline, commodities and microchip industries.
- Leveraged SAS, SQL, and Stata to build and standardize datasets with upwards of 2 billion records, for antitrust consulting clients.
- Provided technical training and mentoring for members of the consulting staff (~120 people).

Services

2025 – 2026: SUNY Binghamton Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL) Advisory Board Member

2022 – 2025: Conference Organizer, Cliometrics Conference

2022 – 2025: Club Water Polo Graduate Student Advisor

2022 – 2024: President of the Economics Graduate Student Organization at Binghamton University

Skills

Languages: English (native)

Computer Skills: SQL (advanced); Visual Basic (basic); SAS (proficient); Stata (advanced); R (proficient); Python (intermediate)

Interests

Economics YouTube Channel: In Case of Econ Struggles—Over 4,800 Subscribers, 400 Videos, and 650,000 views.

Hobbies: Swimming; Water Polo; Aviation Enthusiast

References

Dr. David Slichter: Associate Professor of Economics, Binghamton University.

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Dr. Stephen Wu: Irma M. and Robert D. Morris Professor of Economics, Hamilton College.

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Dr. Sulagna Mookerjee: Associate Professor of Economics, Binghamton University.

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